IN-STORE OPERATIONS · RETAIL

Pick-rate drops force coordinators into manual driver analysis.

Each productivity alert can trigger a multi-source analysis cycle before the coordinator can act.

WHAT THE ROLE IS DOING

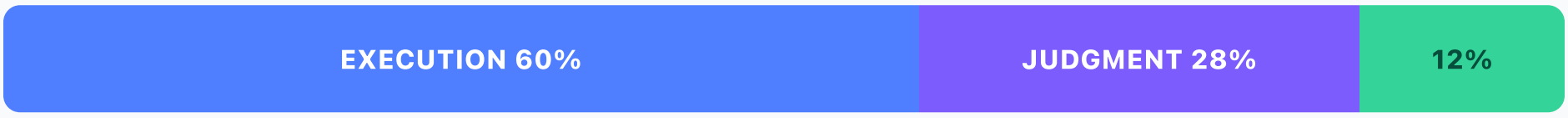
- Pulling pick-task telemetry, exception tickets, and order summaries to compare pick rate, path distance, and order complexity
- Reconciling zone-level productivity drops with exception spikes and changing lines per order across the same dates
- Writing a fresh shift brief that ranks likely causes and proposes actions before backlog worsens

---

WHY THIS COSTS MORE THAN THE HOURS

That manual synthesis delays same-shift intervention and makes labor reassignments more subjective. For this role, the cost is choosing the wrong recovery lever while backlog, overtime, and missed pickup promises continue to build.

Not all of this work requires your judgment.



EXECUTION 60% The execution layer pulls zone-level pick metrics, calculates productivity and deviation thresholds, joins exception and order-mix signals, ranks likely drivers, and formats the briefing output.

JUDGMENT 28% The coordinator still interprets the brief in the context of current staffing, backlog risk, and store conditions, then decides which corrective action to take now.

STRATEGIC 12% Store and operations leaders still own structural decisions such as slotting changes, replenishment process redesign, labor model changes, and pickup policy adjustments.

The execution layer is what a Decision Intelligence workflow handles. The judgment and strategic layers remain yours.

What the workflow does — step by step.

1. **Zone Baseline**
   Measures where pick speed dropped and pinpoints the zones carrying the largest productivity loss.

2. **Driver Attribution**
   Tests whether exceptions and order complexity explain the slowdown alongside zone-level routing evidence.

3. **Driver Brief**
   Ranks the likely causes of the decline and assembles the evidence into a shift-ready summary.

4. **Shift Actions**
   Maps the ranked drivers to the next operational actions for the coming shift window.

Each step queries the warehouse, executes business logic, and passes structured output to the next.

What this workflow does not do.

These decisions belong to the manager.

- It does not decide whether to pull associates from other departments, determine which pickup windows to throttle, approve permanent slotting or bin map changes, choose whether to escalate recurring out-of-stock issues to merchandising or replenishment leadership, or set coaching priorities for individual associates beyond presenting the evidence.

The workflow's job is to get you into the meeting already holding a consistent, defensible analysis. What you do with it is yours.

What the output actually looks like.

WORKFLOW OUTPUT — SAMPLE RESPONSE

Pick productivity fell to 30.0 lines/hour from 38.4 lines/hour, a 21.9% decline over the comparison window.

1. **Routing and bin disruption** — 45% — Average path distance increased from 0.41 km to 0.70 km, with the largest impact concentrated in zones A3 and A4.
2. **Exception rework** — 30% — Exceptions per 100 orders increased from 4.2 to 8.6, indicating materially more interruption and re-pick activity.
3. **Order mix complexity** — 25% — Average lines per order increased from 4.9 to 6.2, which reduced throughput even without a staffing change.

> ► Re-route picks into keep-zone batches for A3 and A4, assign a replenishment runner to those zones, pre-approve substitutions for recurring OOS items, and fast-lane low-line orders during the next 4 hours.

Generated by the Decision Intelligence workflow against sample data.

Run your own value estimate for fulfillment coordinators — or talk to us about your pick productivity recovery workflow.

The Cognitive Labor Value Calculator models team size, role cost, and automation coverage so you can estimate the operational value of removing manual analysis work. It takes under two minutes to complete.

GET IN TOUCH

DM Patterson Consulting on LinkedIn

or find us at pattersonconsultingtn.com